# What’s Driving Returns?



## Returns are impacting profitability, with clear patterns across time, region, and product segments

- **Return rates vary** over time, peaking (39%) in late summer, dropping (17%), then rising again—indicating seasonality

- **The West has the highest return rate (41%) and cost,** while Central remains lowest (11%)

- **Subcategory analysis** reveals two key issues:

  - **Binders and Paper** → high return rates despite lower sales (efficiency issue)
  - **Chairs and Phones** → highest return cost due to volume (financial impact)

- **Technology** has the highest return rate, and a small group of customers drives consistently high returns

**Focus on high return rates (Binders/Paper) and high return costs (Chairs/Phones), especially in the West, to reduce overall impact.**

## Return Rate Is the Best Metric for Identifying Issues

Return rate (%) normalizes for sales volume, enabling fair comparison and revealing true inefficiencies.

- High sales inflate total returns and can be misleading
- Return rate controls for volume and enables fair comparison
- Highlights inefficiencies—not just high-volume products

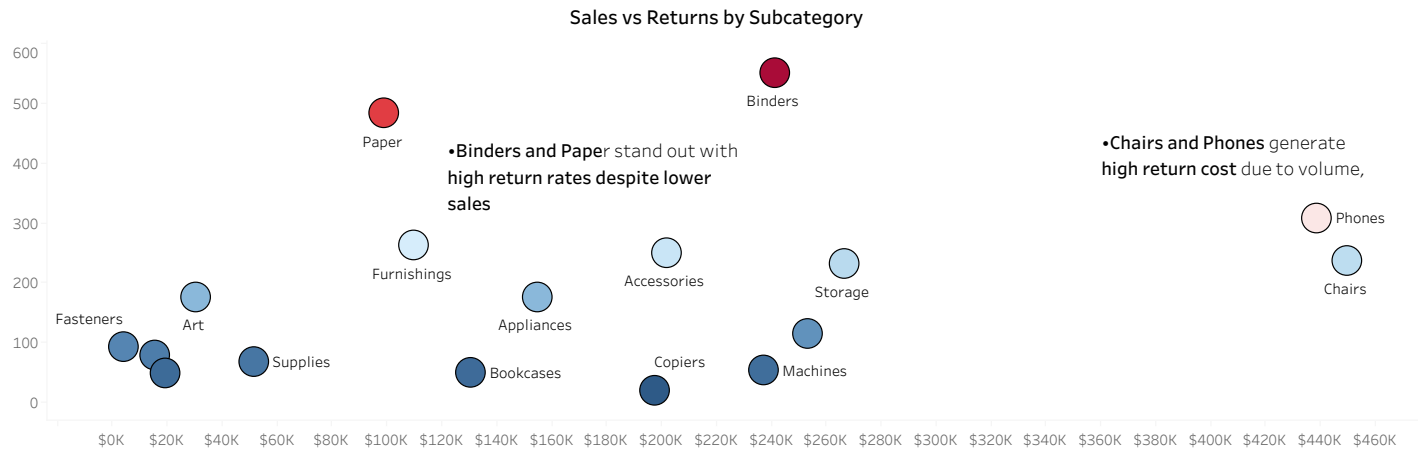
**Use return rate to identify issues; use cost to measure impact.**

# What’s Driving Returns?



## Binders and Paper Show Disproportionately High Return Rates

Return rate reveals inefficiencies that are not visible through sales alone.



# What’s Driving Returns?



## Technology Drives the Highest Return Rates

**Technology** has the **highest return rate** across all categories, indicating **greater risk of returns** compared to Office Supplies and Furniture.

Return Rate by Category

# What’s Driving Returns?



## Returns Are Concentrated Among a Few Customers

A small group of customers drives high return rates, led by **Hilary Holden (100%, 20 returns).**

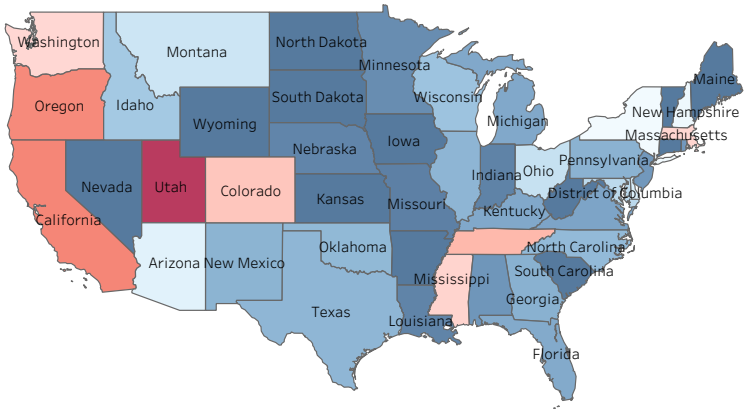
# What’s Driving Returns?



## Returns Are Concentrated in the West

Returns are **highest in the West**, led by **Utah (57%)** and **California (45%)**, while other regions remain stable.

Map of Returns All

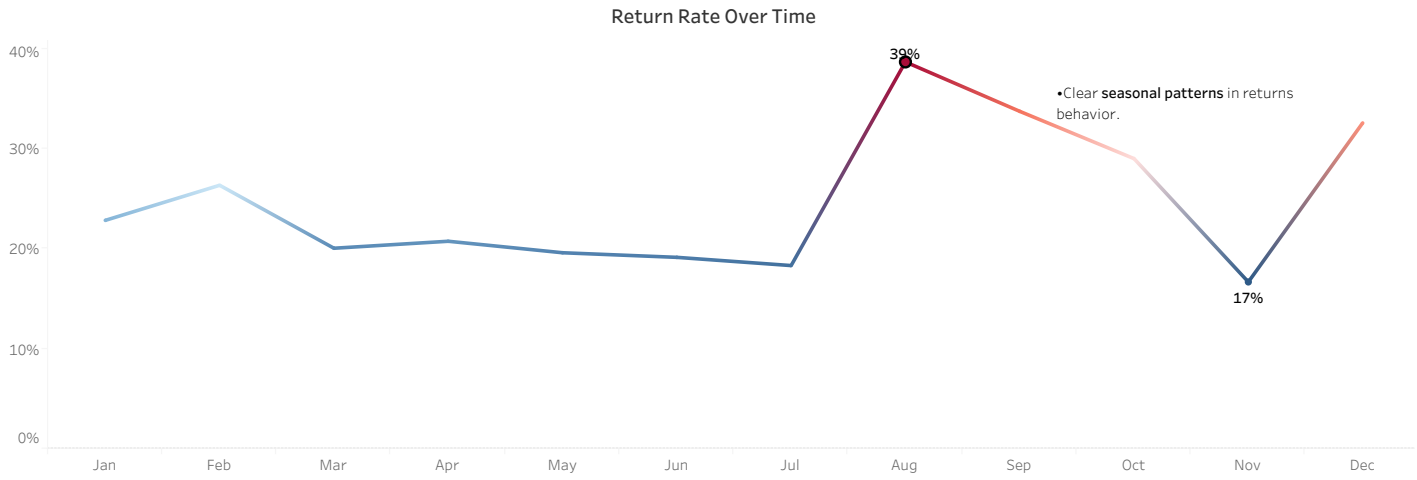


# What’s Driving Returns?



## Returns Peak in Late Summer

Return rates rise sharply to **39% in late summer**, drop to **17%**, then **rebound toward year-end**



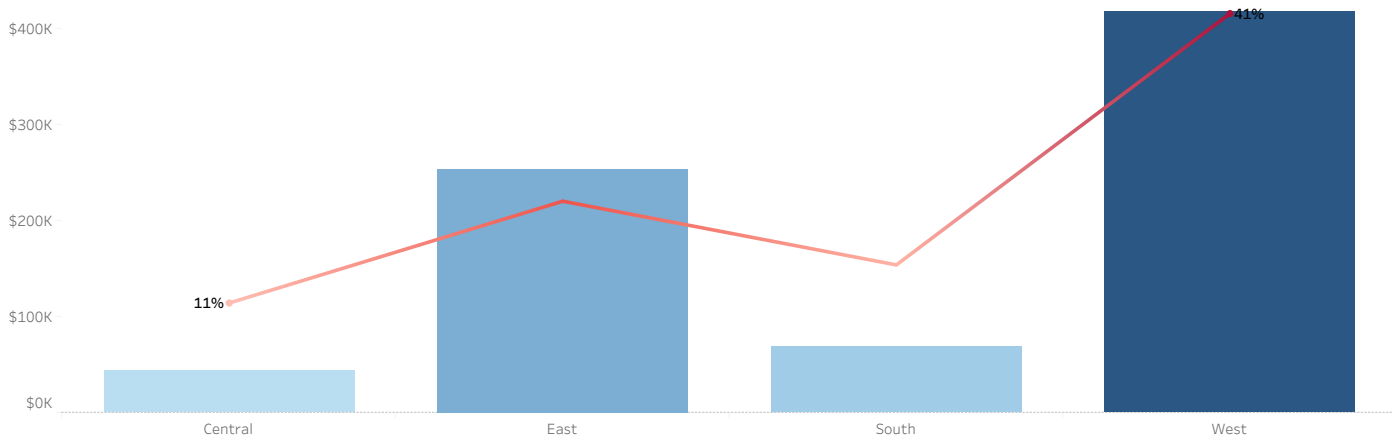
# What’s Driving Returns?



## West Drives Both Return Rate and Cost

The **West** leads in both **return rate (41%) and cost**, far exceeding other regions.

Return Rate vs. Return Cost by Region

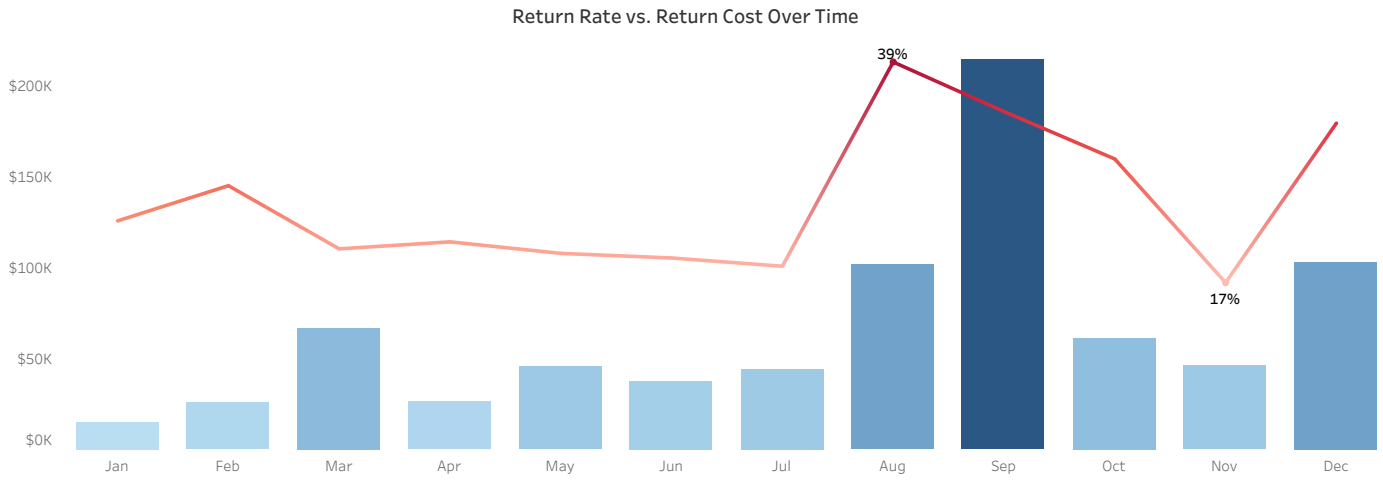


# What’s Driving Returns?



## Peak Return Rate ≠ Peak Return Cost

Return rates **peak in August (39%)**, but the highest return cost occurs later—showing that **high return frequency doesn’t always drive the greatest financial impact.**



## Returns Are Driven by Key Products, Regions, and Customers

- **Products** → Binders & Paper (high return rates)
- **Region** → West (Utah, California)
- **Customers** → Small group drives disproportionate returns
- **Timing** → Late summer spike increases impact

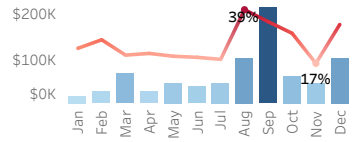
# What’s Driving Returns?



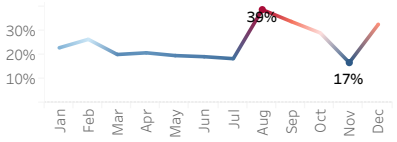
This dashboard enables **interactive exploration** of returns across **products, regions, customers, and time.**

## Return Rate Analysis

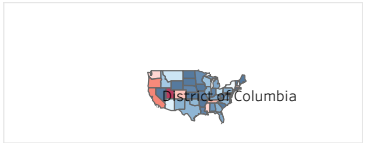
### Return Rate vs. Return Cost Over Time



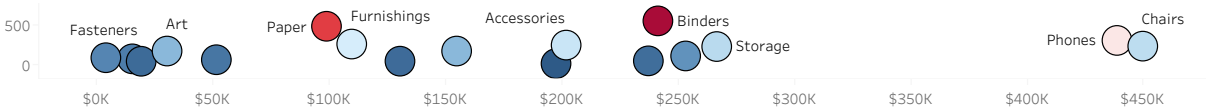

### Return Rate Over Time



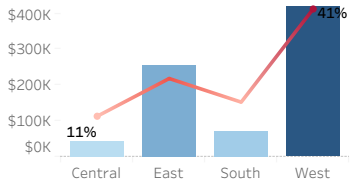

### Map of Returns All



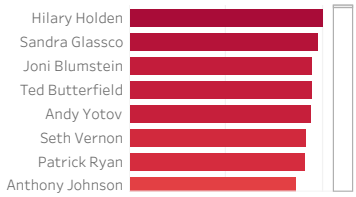

### Sales vs Returns by Subcategory




### Return Rate vs. Return Cost by Region




### Return Rate by Customer




### Return Rate by Category

**Year of Order ..**
All

**State**
All

**Region**
All

**Category**
All

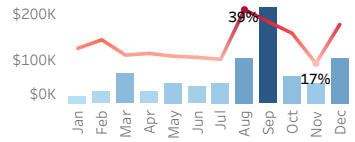
**Sub-Category**
All

# What’s Driving Returns?

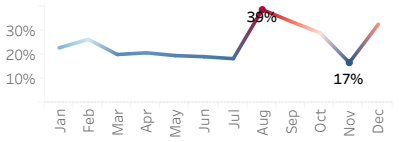


## Return Rate Analysis

### Return Rate vs. Return Cost Over Time

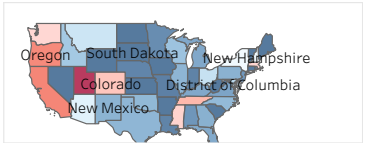



### Return Rate Over Time

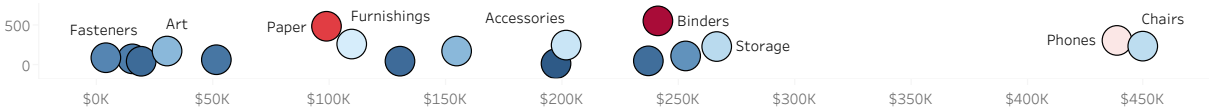



### Map of Returns All

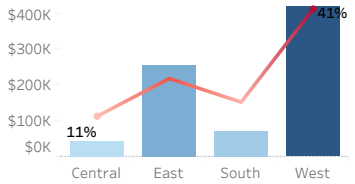
Start here →



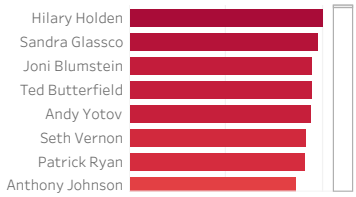

### Sales vs Returns by Subcategory




### Return Rate vs. Return Cost by Region




### Return Rate by Customer




### Return Rate by Category

**Year of Order ..**
All

**State**
All

**Region**
All

**Category**
All

**Sub-Category**
All

Use filters to isolate high-return segments

## Targeted Actions to Reduce Return Rates

- **Products** → Improve quality for Binders & Paper
- **Region** → Address West region fulfillment issues
- **Customers** → Flag and manage high-return behavior
- **Timing** → Plan for late summer demand spikes

## Returns Can Be Reduced Through Targeted Actions

The dashboard enables ongoing monitoring and root cause identification.

### Next Steps:

- **Deploy** dashboard to stakeholders
- **Establish** regular return monitoring
- **Prioritize** high-impact products and regions
- **Track** improvements over time